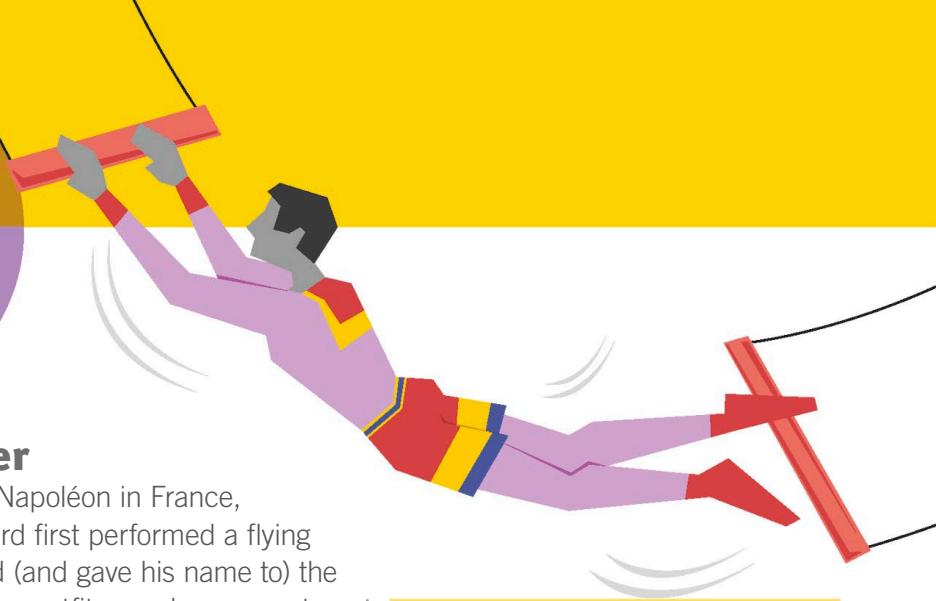


November

12



1859 High-flyer

At the Cirque Napoléon in France, daredevil acrobat Jules Léotard first performed a flying trapeze act. He later invented (and gave his name to) the leotard – a stretchy, tight-fitting outfit worn by gymnasts.

Also on this day

1956 The biggest iceberg on record, larger than Belgium, was spotted off Antarctica by a US Navy ship.

1970 The Bhola tropical cyclone, the most lethal ever, hit East Pakistan (modern-day Bangladesh) and West Bengal, India, killing at least 500,000 people.

1980 The NASA probe *Voyager I* made its closest approach to Saturn and took detailed images of the planet's rings.

Box-kite flight

Australian Lawrence Hargrave proved that a machine heavier than air could fly. He joined four large box kites (his own invention) to a sling seat, and floated 5 m (16 ft) above the ground, anchored by piano wire.

1894



Born this day

1980 Ryan Gosling, Canadian actor and musician. He won a Golden Globe Best Actor award for his role in the musical film *La La Land*.



1966 Space selfie

US astronaut Buzz Aldrin took the first space selfie, outside the spacecraft on the *Gemini 12* mission. These spacewalks paved the way for the first Moon landing.